

The product ladder, and the project catalogue

Revised 4 October 2026. Companion to [Selling-the-books-strategy-and-red-team](Selling-the-books-strategy-and-red-team.md), which covers pricing and go-to-market; this one covers what the products are.

The ladder

	Product	What it is
Start here	The Interview Readiness Book	<i>Be Interview Ready</i> , by Compounza: data science and analytics interview questions with worked answers, from the online test to the first 90 days. The thing Instagram points at. Working price ₹500
Add-on 1	The Three Volumes	First Principles (Parts 0–1), The Working Analyst (Parts 2–3) and Builder to Architect (Parts 4–7), with the practice files arranged by tool. Turns the interview book from a rehearsal into a course. Price to set
Add-on 2	Projects	Standalone, ready-made portfolio projects, bought one at a time. Owner's working figure about ₹150 each, to confirm

Why the volumes are named this way

The series is *Analyst to Architect*, so the three names follow the climb:

Volume	Name	Parts	Why the name fits
1	First Principles	0–1	Part 0 is already titled "First Principles: Data from Zero"; this is the ground floor, no software needed
2	The Working Analyst	2–3	Everything a first analyst job uses day to day, then the advanced analytics that makes a senior one
3	Builder to Architect	4–7	Machine learning, engineering, GenAI and architecture: from building systems to designing them

Inside the PDFs the books still title themselves "Book 1" to "Book 4". Renaming them is a rebuild of all four, waiting on a yes.

What makes a project worth buying

GitHub is full of free code, so a project that is only code loses. Each project carries five things, and the fifth is the product:

A realistic brief	Written the way a manager asks, vague where managers are vague
Messy data	Dates in several formats, duplicates, a broken key, a missing value
A worked, runnable solution	Every output produced by running it, the book's standard
The reasoning	Why this approach and not the obvious one
The interview story	How to describe it in ninety seconds, what will be probed, and the honest answer to "what would you do differently"

The catalogue: eleven projects, by track

Every project below is grounded in material the book already contains: a chapter that teaches the method and, where marked, data or a pipeline that already exists. That is what makes them quick to build and hard to copy. **None is built yet.**

Analyst track

#	Project	What the buyer builds	Built on	Data ready?
P1	The daily report that sends itself	Raw export → cleaned → formatted Excel report → emailed to a list on a schedule. SMTP first, so it works on any laptop; an Outlook variant for Microsoft offices	Ch 18, Ch 20	Yes
P2	The Excel sales dashboard, built and explained	A finished dashboard workbook plus a stripped version to build yourself, step by step	Ch 11, Ch 15	Yes
P3	The Python dashboard	The same story in code, as an interactive dashboard	Ch 18, Ch 15	Yes
P4	The data-cleaning series (three parts, sold separately)	1 · dates and categories · 2 · keys and joins · 3 · validation and reconciliation to the rupee	Ch 14, Ch 72B	Yes, with a truth file , so buyers can check their own answer
P5	Logistics: delivery and stockout analysis	On-time delivery defined properly, stockouts measured from demand, and the branch view	Ch 23 §23.8, Ch 76B Q76B-087	Yes, Riverstone orders and demand
P6	The SQL reporting layer	A set of reviewed, tested queries that a business runs every month; a dbt variant for analytics engineers	Ch 13, Ch 28, Ch 32	Yes

Business analyst track

#	Project	What the buyer builds	Built on	Data ready?
P7	The requirements pack: order-to-cash	A BRD, a swimlane map, user stories with acceptance criteria and a UAT plan for one real process — the BA's portfolio, which almost no BA candidate has	Ch 25, Ch 76B	Yes, the process is fully mapped in Ch 25

Data science track

#	Project	What the buyer builds	Built on	Data ready?
P8	Customer churn, done honestly	A first ML project with the baseline, the leakage check and a "would I ship this?" verdict	Ch 36, Ch 39, Ch 44	Yes
P9	The A/B test readout	Design, analysis and a one-page decision memo for a real experiment	Ch 30	Yes, Riverstone's website test

Engineering and AI track

#	Project	What the buyer builds	Built on	Data ready?
P10	The pipeline that tells you when it breaks	Ingest, clean, load and schedule, with data checks and an alert — the data-engineering CV line	Ch 45, Ch 46, Ch 47	Yes
P11	The email-order intake with an honest evaluation	An LLM pipeline that reads emailed orders, measured on both rates: how much it automates and how much of that is quietly wrong	Ch 55, Ch 58	Yes; Ch 58 measured 88% automatic and 19% of those wrong

Suggested packs

Bundles let a buyer get a track for less than the parts, and they are a natural Instagram offer:

Pack	Projects
Analyst starter	P1 + P2 + P4 (part 1)
BA starter	P7 + P4 (part 1)
Data science starter	P4 (part 1) + P8 + P9
Engineering starter	P10 + P11

Three things to settle before building any of them

1. The support boundary, written on the sales page. At about ₹150 the net is about ₹131 after platform fees, and one support email per sale wipes out the margin. Design support out: pin every version, ship sample data so nothing depends on the buyer's data, test on a clean machine, and state plainly what is and is not covered.

2. How a project differs from the practice files in the volumes. The practice files teach the book; a project is a finished piece of work with a brief, messy data and an interview story. Different purpose, different format. Say it on the page, or a volumes buyer feels double-charged.

3. The projects you already have. Real work beats realistic examples. Send them over and each will get an honest assessment of whether it stands up as a saleable project and what it would need.

Build order

First	P1, as the template every other project follows
Then	P4 , part 1, because its data and truth file already exist
Then	P7 , because no competitor sells a BA portfolio project and the material is ready
In parallel	Set the volumes and project prices, and the support boundary